

4.20

Bad news!

Bad news! This building is not available for the next day of the course. You will have to find somewhere else to have the class for just one day. Your teacher is too busy to help but can give a normal lesson in the new place. You will have to pay any extra costs yourselves. Sorry!

- A** Choose a chairperson. He/She should draw a large grid on the board like the one below. Everyone else work individually and think of two or three ideas for where to have the class. Prepare some arguments. Be specific, for example instead of saying 'in a café', say which café.
- B** Read through stages 1–7 of a formal decision-making process shown below. This is a standard process often used for making complicated decisions. Then use this process to have a meeting to decide where to have your lesson on the next day of the course.

Criteria	weight	Café ?					
1 Cost	x?						
2							
3							
4							
5							

Stages of a formal decision-making process

- 1 Write up all your ideas on a separate part of the board. Brainstorm some more. Then choose the good ones and write them across the top of the grid (Café ? etc.). Don't try to decide which is the best yet.
- 2 Decide which criteria you will use to help choose between the different ideas (cost? noise? etc.). Write them under 'Criteria'.
- 3 Discuss each idea in relation to 'Cost'. Fill in the first row of the grid using a simple three-point system: write 3 for the best alternative/s (in this case the cheapest one/s), 2 for the next best and 1 for the worst (in this case the most expensive).
- 4 Repeat for the other criteria. Fill in the remaining rows.
- 5 Decide how important each criterion is. This is its weight. Use a simple three-point system: write x3 (times three) for the most important criteria, x2 for the next most important and x1 for the least important.
- 6 Multiply each number in the grid by the weight, then cross out the old number and put the new number in its place.
- 7 Add the numbers in each column and put the totals at the bottom. The idea with the highest total is the best choice.

